ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

CV, Interviews and Internships: Get Your First Real Opportunity

Turn a thin CV into a credible application and interview well with little experience

MONEY & CAREER

Money & Career

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Study smarter. Ask better questions. Pass with understanding.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Freshers often believe they have nothing to put on a CV. This pack shows how to convert coursework, volunteering and side projects into evidence of skill, structure a one-page CV, prepare for common interview questions and approach internships without waiting for third year.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Build a one-page CV with clear, evidence-based bullet points.
- Convert coursework and activities into demonstrable skills.
- Prepare answers for common interview questions using a structured method.
- Find and approach internship opportunities professionally.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

A CV that survives screening

A recruiter skims for relevance. Make the first screen easy.

- One page, clean layout, consistent formatting, no photograph unless requested.
- Order: contact, education, skills, experience and projects, leadership, references.
- Use action verbs and quantify where possible: 'organised five tutorials for 30 students'.
- Tailor the top third of the CV to the opportunity.
- Remove secondary-school details once you have university results.
- Check spelling of names, dates and contact details.

> **No experience is still experience**
> Course projects, volunteering, tutoring, a small business and committee roles all demonstrate reliability and skill. Describe what you did and the result.

Interview preparation

Preparation is visible. Practise in full sentences, not in your head.

- Prepare a two-minute introduction covering who you are, what you study and what you want.
- Use the situation-action-result structure for behavioural questions.
- Prepare examples for teamwork, conflict, failure and initiative.
- Research the organisation enough to ask one intelligent question.
- Prepare your own questions about the role and expectations.
- Dress appropriately, arrive early and switch off your phone.

Finding internships and attachments

Start earlier than the deadline and use more than one channel.

- Departmental industrial training coordinators and notice boards.
- Faculty and alumni networks; a warm introduction beats a cold email.
- Small firms and startups, which are often more accessible than large companies.
- Professional associations and student chapters.
- A short email stating what you study, what you can do and what you are asking for.
- Follow up once after a week; persistence done politely is not harassment.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. How should a CV bullet point be written?

Answer: Start with an action verb, state what you did and include a result or scale, for example 'managed a WhatsApp group of 120 students and increased assignment submission rates'.

2. What does the situation-action-result structure mean?

Answer: Describe the context, the action you took and the result achieved, so the interviewer can assess your behaviour.

3. Why tailor a CV for each application?

Answer: Screening looks for relevance; tailored documents show alignment with the specific role.

4. What should you include in an internship enquiry email?

Answer: Your course and level, relevant skills, the specific attachment you are requesting, dates and availability, and a polite request for consideration.

5. How should you follow up on an application?

Answer: Send one concise, polite message after about a week, restating your interest and availability.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Write a one-page CV and have it reviewed by a senior colleague.
- [ ] List five skills with one concrete example each.
- [ ] Write your two-minute self-introduction.
- [ ] Prepare answers for three behavioural questions.
- [ ] Identify three organisations you can approach.
- [ ] Send one internship enquiry email.
- [ ] Practise a mock interview with a friend.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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